Past simple: regular and irregular verbs

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Talk about finished actions in the past (acciones terminadas)
- Add -ed to regular verbs with the right spelling
- Learn the most common irregular verbs
- Make negatives and questions with did / didn't

Para pensar

En español decimos «ayer jugué» y «ayer fui». En inglés, «jugué» es *played*, pero «fui» no es «goed». ¿Por qué?

Explicación

What is the past simple?

We use the past simple for actions that **started and finished in the past**: «I **visited** my cousins last summer», «We **watched** a film yesterday». We often say **when** it happened.

En castellano: equivale a nuestro pretérito: «visité», «vimos». Una gran ventaja del inglés: el verbo **no cambia** según la persona. «I played», «you played», «he played», «they played». ¡No hay que memorizar seis terminaciones como en español!



Regular verbs: -ed

Regular verbs add -ed: walk → walk**ed**, play → play**ed**, watch → watch**ed**, help → help**ed**.

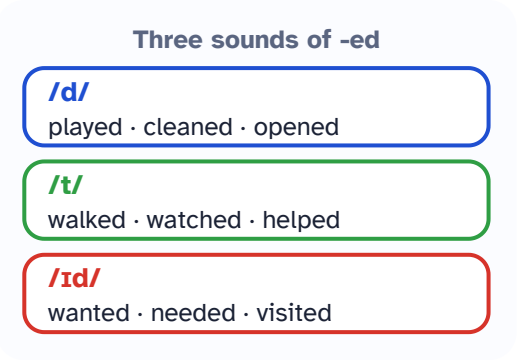
Spelling rules: verbs ending in -e add only **-d**: like → lik**ed**, dance → danc**ed**. Consonant + y changes to **-ied**: study → stud**ied**, cry → cr**ied** (but play → played, because a vowel comes before the y). Short verbs ending in consonant + vowel + consonant double the last letter: stop → sto**pp**ed, plan → pla**nn**ed.

Verb	Past
walk	walked
like	liked
study	studied
stop	stopped

How do you say -ed?

The ending *-ed* has three sounds. After most sounds it is /d/: played, cleaned, opened. After sounds like p, k, s, sh, ch it is /t/: walked («wokt»), watched («wocht»), helped («helpt»).

After **t** or **d** it is a new syllable /ɪd/: wanted («uóntid»), needed («nídid»), visited. **En castellano:** casi nunca se pronuncia «-ed» completo; solo cuando el verbo acaba en t o d. Di en voz alta: «I **walked** to the park and I **wanted** an ice cream».



Irregular verbs

Many common verbs are irregular: they don't add -ed. You need to learn them by heart (de memoria). Here are some of the most useful: go → **went**, have → **had**, eat → **ate**, see → **saw**, buy → **bought**, get → **got**, make → **made**, come → **came**, take → **took**, write → **wrote**, swim → **swam**, run → **ran**.

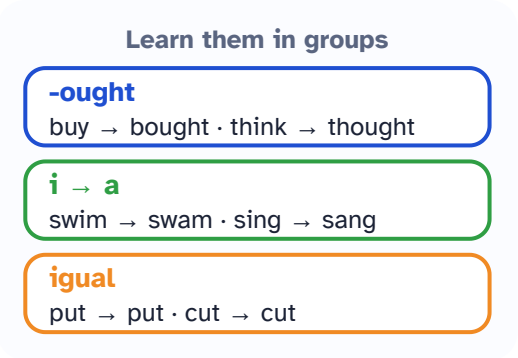
The verb **to be** has two forms: **was** (I, he, she, it) and **were** (you, we, they). «It **was** sunny», «We **were** at the beach».

Verb	Past	Verb	Past
go	went	see	saw
have	had	buy	bought
eat	ate	make	made
come	came	write	wrote

Tricks to learn irregular verbs

Group them by sound and it's easier (agrúpalos por cómo suenan). **-ought / -aught:** buy → bought, bring → brought, think → thought, teach → taught. **i → a:** swim → swam, sing → sang, drink → drank, begin → began. **Same form:** put → put, cut → cut, hit → hit.

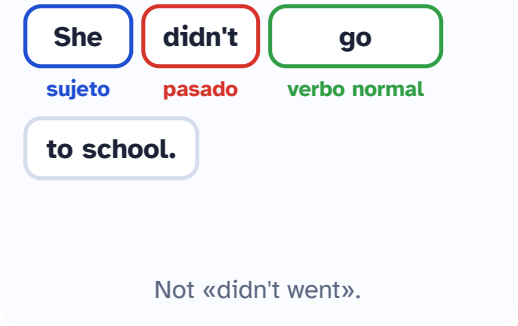
Make flashcards (tarjetas): the verb on one side, the past on the other. Practise five verbs a day. Sing them with a rhythm: «go, went – see, saw – eat, ate!». **En castellano:** no intentes aprender cien de golpe; los veinte más usados ya cubren casi todo.



Negatives with didn't

To make a negative we use `didn't` (did not) + the verb in its **normal form**: «`I` **didn't play** football yesterday», «She **didn't go** to school». Careful: after *didn't* we never use the past: not «didn't went».

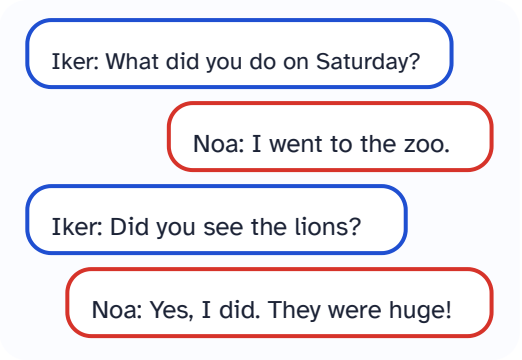
The verb **to be** is different: it doesn't need *didn't*. We say «`I` **wasn't** tired», «They **weren't** at home». **En castellano:** *did* ya lleva el pasado; por eso el verbo vuelve a su forma básica, igual que en el presente con *doesn't*.



Questions with did

For questions we put Did at the beginning and the verb in its normal form: «**Did** you **enjoy** the trip?» – «Yes, I did. / No, I didn't». «**Did** he **see** the dolphins?» – «Yes, he did».

With question words: «**Where did** you go?», «**What did** you eat?», «**When did** they arrive?». With **to be**: «**Was** it fun?», «**Were** you scared?». Time words for the past: **yesterday, last night, last week, last summer, two days ago, in 2024**.



Reading: my best holiday

Read Hugo's text: «Last summer I **went** to Asturias with my family. We **stayed** in a small house near the sea. On the first day it **rained**, so we **visited** a museum. Then the sun **came** out and we **swam** every day. I **tried** cheese from the mountains – it **was** delicious! We **didn't take** many photos, but I **wrote** a diary. It **was** the best holiday ever.»

Find six regular verbs and six irregular ones. Which verbs are in the negative?

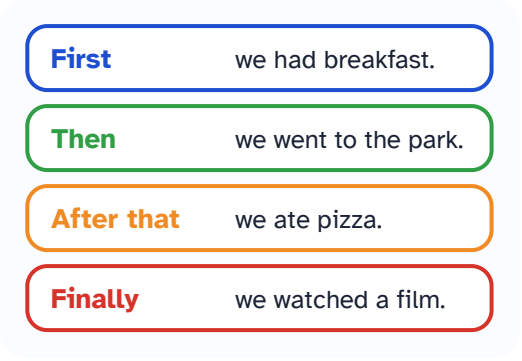


Let's practise: guess my weekend

Play in groups. Write three sentences about last weekend: two true and one false (una falsa). «I **went** to the cinema. I **ate** sushi. I **played** tennis». Your classmates

ask questions to find the false one: «**Did you go** with your family?», «**What film did you see**?».

Then write a short text about a special day. Use time order words: **first, then, after that, finally**. **Consejo:** repasa al final si cada verbo está en pasado y si después de *did* has usado la forma normal.



Past simple

regular	irregular	negative	question
-ED	**WENT**	**DIDN'T**	**DID...?**
played, liked studied, stopped	ate, saw bought, made	didn't go + normal verb	Did you go? Yes, I did.

Ejercicios

1. **Write the past: play, like, cry, plan.**

2. **Write the past: go, eat, see, buy.**

3. **Complete with was or were: «The film ___ great. We ___ happy.»**

4. **Make it negative: «He wrote a letter.»**

5. **Make a question: «You had lunch at school.»**

6. **How do you pronounce -ed in «wanted», «watched», «played»?**

7. **Correct: «Yesterday I swimmed in the pool.»**

8. **Answer: «Did you watch TV last night?» (no)**

9. **Translate: «La semana pasada visitamos a mi abuela.»**

10. **Write three sentences about your last birthday.**

Practica

1. **The past of «walk» is...**
   - **A)** walkt
   - **B)** walked
   - **C)** walk
2. **The past of «go» is...**
   - **A)** goed
   - **B)** gone
   - **C)** went
3. **The past of «study» is...**
   - **A)** studied
   - **B)** studyed
   - **C)** studed
4. **«___ you enjoy the party?»**
   - **A)** Do
   - **B)** Were
   - **C)** Did
5. **«She didn't ___ the bus.»**
   - **A)** took
   - **B)** take
   - **C)** takes
6. **«They ___ at the beach yesterday.»**
   - **A)** were
   - **B)** was
   - **C)** did
7. **The past of «eat» is...**
   - **A)** eated
   - **B)** ate
   - **C)** eaten
8. **Which is a past time expression?**
   - **A)** every day

B) now

C) two days ago

9. **The past of «stop» is...**

A) stopped

B) stoped

C) stopt

10. **In «wanted», -ed sounds...**

A) /t/

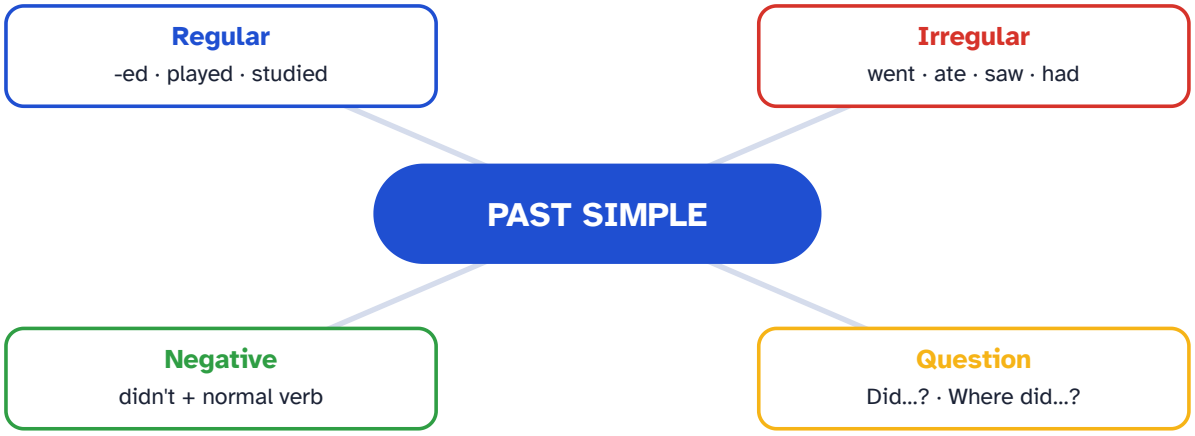
B) /ɪd/

C) /d/

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve el pasado simple; Cómo se forma el pasado de los verbos regulares y su ortografía; Qué son los verbos irregulares y algunos ejemplos; Cómo se hacen negativas y preguntas con did.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

Past simple

Acciones terminadas en el pasado.

-ed

Pasado regular: walked, played.

-ied / doble consonante

studied · stopped.

go → went

Irregular muy frecuente.

was / were

Pasado de to be.

didn't + verbo

Negativa: I didn't go.

Did...?

Pregunta: Did you see it?

ago

Hace: two days ago = hace dos días.

Soluciones

1. **B)** Regular: + -ed.
2. **C)** Irregular.
3. **A)** Consonante + y → -ied.
4. **C)** Pregunta en pasado: Did.
5. **B)** Tras didn't, forma normal.
6. **A)** They + were.
7. **B)** Irregular.
8. **C)** Ago = hace.
9. **A)** Se dobla la p.
10. **B)** Tras t o d, sílaba nueva.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. played, liked, cried, planned.
2. went, ate, saw, bought.
3. was, were.
4. He didn't write a letter.
5. Did you have lunch at school?
6. /ɪd/, /t/, /d/.
7. Yesterday I swam in the pool.
8. No, I didn't.
9. Last week we visited my grandma.
10. Model answer: I had a party. My friends came to my house. We ate a chocolate cake.